

February 2021

Seniors United Now

SUNBURST

The Newsletter for Seniors United Now

Sherwood Business Center – Park Centre Hotel
#37 15 - 2016 Sherwood Drive, Sherwood Park, AB T8A3X3
Telephone 780-449-1816 Toll Free 1-855-786-8669
www.seniorsunitednow.com
Email unite-now@telus.net

1st Quarter 2021
Issue 52



The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

Notice is hereby given that the Annual General Meeting of Alberta Seniors United Now Society

will be held as follows:

Wednesday April 28th, 2021

Virtual Zoom Meeting*

9:30am – 9:55am Meeting Sign-in Attendance

Meeting Commences 10:00 am

Keynote Speaker: Patricia Morgan
Solutions for Resilience

For the purpose of:

1. President's Report
2. Receiving and considering financial statements for the year ended December 31, 2020 and the report of the auditors thereon
3. Electing Directors
4. Transacting such further business as may properly come before the meeting or any adjournment thereof

Dated 22nd day of February 2021

Registration Requested see page 10 for information.

Online registration: www.seniorsunitednow.com

page 12 for registration form

*Zoom account is not required to participate

Contents

President	3
Executive Director	8

Chapter News

Edmonton North East	5
Sherwood Park /	
Strathcona County	6
Edmonton South	7
Edmonton North West	7
St. Albert	10
Calgary	10

Membership

Member Renewal Dates	3
Cash Raffle Winner	3
Volunteer Virtues - we salute	4
AGM Registration Information	10
Volunteer Virtue - Cash Raffle	11
Renewal / Donation Form	11
Are You Due?	12
AGM Registration Form	12

Special Interest / Articles

Understanding Loneliness	
Patricia Morgan	2
Johnson Insurance Testimonial	4
Social Isolation	5
Covid-19 Vaccine - AHS	8
CARP Office of Seniors Advocate	9
CRA – What to expect	10

Understanding Loneliness

What to Do for Yourself and Others



Most of us feel lonely some of the time and others chronically feel lonely. Researcher, Julianne Holt-Lunstad, concluded that loneliness doubles the odds for increased mortality, obesity, and physical illness. Then on October 14, 2020, the Angus Reid Institute reported that the number of Canadians indicating they have a good social life has dropped from 55 percent in 2019 to 33 percent. Certainly, COVID-19 has added to the problem of loneliness.

The good news is, once we name a problem, it is half solved. Join us as we explore how to meaningfully relate to ourselves, our loved ones, and those we know who would benefit from an uplifting connection.

You will:

1. Gain clarity on the difference between isolation, being lonely, and being alone.
2. Understand the Three L's of Connection.
 - 1) Loved and supported
 - 2) Liked and liking
 - 3) Lifestyle
3. Assess your own degree of loneliness and need for connection.
4. Have ways to better attend to your own and others' mental wellness through meaningful connection.



Patricia Morgan is often referred to as a Spunky Seniorpreneur. Her ability to provide bite-sized knowledge nuggets for resilience has helped many people emerge stronger after facing unthinkable challenge. With a MA in Clinical Psychology, she has authored several books on resilience, stress management, and women's issues including the acclaimed *Love Her As She Is: Lessons from a Daughter Stolen by Addictions*.

She is a recipient of Global TV's Woman of Vision award and the Canadian Association of Professional Speakers' Spirit of CAPS award for her contribution to the Canadian speaking industry. She is described as a therapeutic counsellor, speaker, author, mentor, mother to three, grandmother to five, and great-grandmother to two. Check her out at www.SolutionsForResilience.com

Questions about seniors programs and services?

211 now provides enhanced information and referrals for a variety of seniors resources



Dial 2-1-1 to be connected to the Seniors Information Phone Line

If you are feeling particularly isolated these days, you are not alone. To help you connect with others, several seniors' organizations are offering friendly calls. To get on a friendly call list, call 211 and press "2". You will be referred to a friendly call program to receive calls from a friendly volunteer on a regular, recurring basis.

211 is a helpline and website that provides information on and referrals to Alberta's community, social, health-related and government services. The vision for 211 Alberta is to be the primary source of information and gateway to human services for individuals and planners.

SUN BOARD OF DIRECTORS 2020 – 2021

Gordon Voth - President Wayne Sorenson - Vice President William Holtz – Treasurer
Dellah Cohlmin - Secretary Gerald Northam – Director Bert Reich - Director
Robert Price – Director Stan Poznanski – Director

SUN STAFF

Linda Osborne - Executive Director 780-920-3058 sunexdir@telus.net
Deborah Wilson – SUN Membership Coordinator 780-999-2313 suncoord@telus.net
Lynn Penner - Office Administration 780-449-1816 unitenow@telus.net

Presidents Report

I have lived through a few memorable years in the past, but I suspect that the years 2020 and 2021 will be the ones that will be talked about across Canada for generations to come. I think, as 9/11 has changed air travel, so will COVID-19 have an ever-lasting impact on our lives going forward. It will also have a profound impact on SUN as we will have to rethink who we are and how will we be effective advocates as we move into post COVID-19. The board is planning on having zoom strategic planning meetings to discuss these issues and to plot a future course for SUN and our members.

Our vision is to be “The voice of seniors in Alberta”. We have been successful in the past, by responding to governmental policy proposals that we consider may negatively impact seniors in Alberta. We developed position papers, outlining our concerns, and encouraged policy adjustments based on fairness for seniors. Our successes were based on mutually beneficial relationships with governmental ministers and their willingness to receive advice.

We may have to modify this approach, in dealing with the government, and involving SUN in their decision-making process. Organizations reacting to the government’s decision-making process are being regarded by politicians as being negative and anti-government. This is not our mandate. We see SUN as a partner, working with the government, as we seek to develop the most creative, innovative, and financially responsible and truly participate in the well-being of the province.

On a membership note, the board has a comprehensive plan to continue to communicate effectively and timely to all SUN members during this pandemic. We accomplish this by publishing our newsletter, SUNBURST, three times a year, in addition we send out E-Bulletins with updates between newsletters. We plan to return to in-person chapter meetings in September 2021, if safe to do so. In the meantime, the chapters are providing guest speakers to communicate to our members by zoom. We would encourage all our members to join in from home.

Our advocacy program continues to be of service to our members by telephone or e-mail. These calls are all responded to and we jointly seek solutions for these issues. Unfortunately, we are not able to meet with ministers, but we continue to communicate by letters, phone, and email.

During these trying times, I would urge our members to stay in touch with family and friends, by phone, zoom, skype, and facetime. It is important to maintain our contacts during this pandemic. Keep well and help others.

Gordon Voth



CASH RAFFLE – Winners

Solstice Dough December 21, 2020

License #566309

Congratulations to SUN members:

Ticket #0060 C.Veeken – Sherwood Park

Ticket #0571 S.Zinyk – Sherwood Park

Thanks to all members for supporting SUN’s critical fundraising by purchasing tickets!

ADMINISTRATION MODIFICATION TO MEMBERSHIP RENEWAL DUE DATES

To simplify administrative labor, renewal months will be slightly changed for some members.

1st Quarter - **JANUARY** (January February & March)

2nd Quarter – **APRIL** (April, May & June)

3rd Quarter - **SEPTEMBER** (July, August & September)

4th Quarter – **NOVEMBER** (October, November & December)

Memberships are considered current until the **END** of the quarter in which they are due for renewal.

Thanks for your understanding. Lynn Penner – Office Admin

Volunteer Virtues ...We Salute YOU our Volunteers

Not everyone can be a philanthropic giver, but most everyone can be a volunteer. You do not have to have wealth or material resource; you just need to have time, heart, and a sense of adventure. Volunteering is not only good for society--organizations like Seniors United Now depend on it--but it is good for you, the Volunteer.

Unfortunately, the number of volunteers has steadily declined for decades, at one time being as high as 35-40%. This decline is not a good trend and gives all the more reason for the Virtues of Volunteering to be promoted.

Volunteering is good for us--research definitively proves Volunteers live longer and are healthier! In fact, during later life. Older people who volunteer remain physically functional longer, have more robust psychological wellbeing, and live longer. Volunteering helps us transcend the narrow boundaries of our lifestyle routines and engage a broader, deeper world which can only enrich us.

Being a Volunteer creates new relationships and new perspectives. Despite all the online, social media connections that are available at our fingertips, people are lonelier now than ever before. It is no surprise, and incredibly sad, that current studies report that loneliness is at an all-time high. Volunteering can be a great "loneliness" antidote for the volunteer and the recipient. Being a Volunteer improves all areas of one's life. Most people live within very tight, narrow, somewhat sheltered boundaries. By expanding personal horizons, helping others, being part of a team, helping solve social problems, building a better community. Volunteering has a reverberating positive effect!

Volunteering provides an expanded Sense of Purpose. Volunteering serves to express and facilitate opportunities to carry out one's sense of purpose. The very nature of volunteering means choosing to work without being paid for it.

"Volunteering is the ultimate exercise in democracy. You vote in elections once a year, but when you Volunteer, you vote every day about the kind of community you want to live in." (Author unknown)



NATIONAL VOLUNTEER WEEK
APRIL 18-24, 2021



Remembering a special volunteer



Albert Allan Smale, a long-time member of SUN who served on the

South Edmonton Chapter Executive, passed away suddenly and peacefully on January 3, 2021, at the age of 79. He is survived by his wife Beth, their six children, ten grandchildren, and one great-grandson. A private service for the family was held in January, but a celebration of his life will be held later in the year. In lieu of flowers, donations can be sent to the Edmonton Food Bank, where Al volunteered his services for many years. Al also was a member the Boilermakers Union for 55 years, in addition, Al was a member of the New Democratic Party as an executive member and worked on many political campaigns.

Testimonial – Johnson Insurance

As a long-time member of SUN, I was aware of the Johnson Insurance relationship with Seniors United Now and the benefits to SUN members. This past fall I took the time to reach out to Johnson Insurance for a quote as a member of SUN. The Johnson representative was friendly and efficient, I was happy and a little surprised to receive a significant discount on my house and automobile insurance. I suggest all SUN members that carry insurance, to consider making that call.

SUN Member - Keith H.

1.877.742.7490 Johnson Ins.
Johnson.ca/savings HOME CAR



E-Mail Communication

SUN Administrator

newsletter@seniorsunitednow.com

We thank all those members that have subscribed to our electronic communications that are sent out via our Website program. If you have not yet subscribed, you may do this by visiting our website and clicking JOIN OUR EMAIL LIST.

What communications are sent out?

Messages, information, and updates to all our members including the invitations to participate in the zoom virtual meetings. As these are preprogrammed messages sent in bulk, some members have had situations where their computer virus security program is automatically "unsubscribe" from our email communications. We suggest that this may be alleviated by adding the newsletter SUN administrator address newsletter@seniorsunitednow.com into your personal contacts.

North East Edmonton Chapter

Quarterly Activity Summary

Because of the current COVID-19 Pandemic, for me it is only a distant memory, when we all enjoyed our face-to-face chapter meetings. We all enjoyed the socializing, the sharing of coffee, pastries and listening to Seniors' United Now pro-actions and accomplishments. As well, we always learnt from our senior's topical educational presentations, conducted by our guest speakers.

We are excited to expand our audience to all SUN chapters and members throughout the Province of Alberta. We hope that you will consider joining in on our series of Zoom Virtual Meetings. Join us to stay connected, stay informed, and voice our thoughts on issues and concerns that matter to seniors.

If you wish to participate in the Zoom meetings you may do so by computer or telephone. Prior to each meeting an email invitation, to join the meeting, is sent out to all SUN members that have enlisted in our email program via our website. You may also contact the SUN office by either sending an email or by telephoning to get the zoom link information. Please note a zoom account is **NOT** required to participate in the sessions.

Our initial zoom session was Feb 11, 2021 Topic: Slam the Scam, this was an informative session presented by Arleigh Hrycaiko-Assié, Outreach Officer Canada Revenue Agency / Government of Canada. The participation in the question-and-answer portion was excellent and everyone enjoyed her presentation. See page 10, What to Expect when CRA contacts you, for some of the information she shared with our 43 attendees.

Our upcoming meetings are:

March 11, 2021 - Jolyn Hall - Owner of Edmonton 55, her presentation will be "Do you stay or do you move?"

April 8, 2021 - A United Way trained facilitator will present "Financial Wellness for Seniors".

May 13, 2021 & June 10, 2021 Topics & Speakers to be announced.



We encourage and appreciate those of you that can attend these presentations!

Wayne Sorenson Chairperson, Edmonton North East Chapter

Social Isolation

Social Isolation of seniors has been an issue of concern to the Seniors United Now Board of Directors for many years. In the October 2018 SUNBURST 45, there was an in-depth article on social isolation published, which shows this topic is certainly not new, but has now become a crisis in our current society. Below is an abbreviated glimpse of the previous article.

Social isolation occurs when seniors have limited quality connections with others. We know social isolation contributes to poor health, loneliness, and emotional distress. The COVID-19 pandemic has brought social isolation to a crisis point. "The question becomes, how do we look at social distancing to protect seniors physically but still engage them socially?"

Stay in touch, while this may seem obvious, it is not always easy. Some seniors are not comfortable with the technology that could keep them connected. It may be tempting to give the octogenarian in your life an iPad, but now's not the time to introduce new devices. We suggest an old-fashioned phone call. If you are concerned about keeping a senior engaged on the phone, go into the conversation with a specific shared memory so you can both reminisce. Ask a grandparent to read or tell a bedtime story to kids. It is also important to end the talk with a reminder that you will call again soon. Even phone calls will not work for all seniors, particularly those who are hard of hearing. Mailing seniors, a letter with old photos of themselves with family and friends, labelled clearly with names and dates.

Suggest helping others...In times of crisis, all of us need something constructive to do. Seniors, like anybody else, like to help people, so encourage them to call their neighbors, family, friends and check on them. They too can reach out to others.

It is critical to human beings to have social interaction. This really underscores the importance of doing something now.

Sherwood Park / Strathcona County Chapter (SPSC)**Quarterly Activity Summary**

We are excited to expand our audience to all SUN chapters and members in the entire Province of Alberta. We hope that you will consider joining in on our series of Zoom Virtual Meetings. Stay connected, stay informed, and voice our thoughts on issues and concerns that matter to seniors.

If you wish to participate in the Zoom meetings you may do so by computer or telephone. Prior to each meeting an email invitation, to join the meeting, is sent out to all SUN members that have joined our email program via our website. You may also contact the SUN office by either sending an email or by telephoning to get the zoom link information. Please note a zoom account is **NOT** required to participate in the sessions.

March 16, 2021 Topic: China: What should Canada's Position Be?

Speaker: Garnett Genuis, Sherwood Park - Member of Parliament Shadow Cabinet Minister for Foreign Affairs

May 18, 2021 Topic: Family History - It is more than Names and Dates (Tentative) Speaker: Ellen Thompson-Jennings
Family History Hound/Shop the Hound

June 15, 2021 Topic: Saving Manno - An Alberta man's quest to rescue a chimpanzee from Iraq

Speaker: Spencer Sekyer, Author - Bursting with compassion, inspiration, and courage, Saving Manno is a testament to the fact that every one of us has the power to change lives and make the world a better place.

The Devastating Effects of Social Isolation on Seniors

COVID-19 has impacted seniors the most. In many ways much more than any other segment of the population especially those in Long Term Care and Assisted Living. We all know about the horror stories of many seniors in nursing homes across our great nation who have succumbed to COVID-19. Others have gone through the illness and are still suffering from the aftereffects; many have inherited chronic lung conditions or other forms of ailments that will be with them until their dying days. My own mother at 92 years of age tested positive for COVID-19 but luckily experienced only a mild cough for a couple of days. What has been much more deadly to her and the rest of these folks is the constant isolation of not being allowed to visit anyone or be visited except by special permission. Almost everyone in the "outside world" shops in the stores, goes for walks outside, drive in their cars, or can socialize within some kind of a family unit but these poor seniors are relegated to lockdown and social isolation day after day, month after month and it is taking its toll. The constant isolation is breaking their spirit, wearing them down and bringing on their dementia and affecting their mental health. Please continue to reach out to all seniors especially the ones that are living alone and are shut-in or locked down.

Report respectfully submitted by:

Denis Beaudry Chairperson, SPSC Chapter

Join us! We welcome your wisdom, experience, and enthusiasm!

**Senior Classic Chuckles**

What are seniors worth anyway? They are worth a fortune, with all the silver in their hair, gold in their teeth, stones in their kidneys and lead in their feet.

Girl Talk

Well, I have become a little older since I saw you last, and a few changes have come into my life. Frankly, I have become quite a frivolous old gal. I am seeing several gentlemen every day. As soon as I wake up, Will Power helps me get out of bed. After that Charlie Horse comes along, and he really takes a lot of my time and attention. Then it is time for breakfast with Mr. Kellogg, followed closely by the refreshing company of Mr. Tetley. When he leaves, Arthur Ritis shows up and stays for the rest of the day. However, he does not like to stay in one place, so he just takes me from joint to joint. Finally, after such a busy tiring day, I am glad to be able to go to bed with Johnny Walker. What a life!!

Author Unknown

South Edmonton Chapter**A message to our chapter members**

We are now close to the 1st anniversary of the COVID-19 lockdown, and South Edmonton has not held a presentation since the beginning of March 2020. The executive has been in contact with our members through two phone calls each during the last six months. We wanted to keep up everybody's spirits and had some good conversations with some of the members. Also, we informed them about decisions made at the Board level, which we have attended monthly through zoom. Others received e mails from the office.

The Whitemud Public Library facilities for our presentations has been closed since March 2020. So far, we have not received any information about a possible reopening, and it does not look promising due to a combination of COVID-19 variants and slow vaccinations here in Alberta. The Board recently decided to plan establishing regular chapter meetings in September 2021, but there is no guarantee that it might be possible.

Sadly, one of our long-time members who served on the executive, Al Smale, passed away on January 6, 2021. A card was sent on behalf of SUN by South Chapter to his wife, Beth, and her family. Furthermore, on the family's request, we sent a donation to the Edmonton Food Bank where Al volunteered his services for many years. This is a great loss as Al was a dedicated and dependable member of our executive at our meetings and always volunteered for work at the AGM.

We would greatly appreciate if anyone would like to volunteer to serve on our executive, as we are now reduced to a team of six. Anyone familiar with the use of zoom would be of great benefit to our group. Other chapters have had virtual meetings through zoom, so perhaps we might have to look at that as an option. Check the contact below if you are interested and willing to join the executive and feel free to contact us at any time.

Also, when you receive the Sunburst, please check the date on the last page about when your membership is due. We must keep active in SUN and do what we can to help financially and otherwise until this crisis is over. If you have any issues of concern such as an advocacy matter, or any suggestions, please contact the executive or the office.

We missed our annual executive gathering in 2020, celebrating us, and our volunteer spirit, which is usually held just prior to Christmas. We are looking forward and hope to resume it this year.

Cynthia Lazarenko and Robert Price
Co-chairs Edmonton South Chapter
Contact: Bob at 780-250-7164 and email: rogp@shaw.ca

**North West Edmonton Chapter****A message to our chapter members**

We will re-start our in-person NW Edmonton meetings when we can safely gather, and we will let you know when that will happen. I expect there will be a lot of interest in meeting topics related to the fall out from the current health crisis. Both physical health and mental well-being.

In the meantime, we encourage you to join in on the zoom meetings being hosted by Edmonton NE and Sherwood Park Chapters and of course our Annual General Meeting on April 28th 2021, needs your participation.

Your support and talents are wanted, please consider volunteering for our Chapter.

COVID-19 Vaccine

www.albertahealthservices.ca

Alberta Health Services is the only authorized means of vaccine delivery in Alberta. Any offers to provide vaccination to the public for a fee are not legitimate and should be reported to your local law enforcement agency's anti-fraud/scam unit via the police non-emergency telephone line.

Q: When will the COVID-19 vaccine be available to the general public? A: Fall 2021 (Phase 3) is the current estimate.

Q: Can I join a waitlist to be prioritized? A: No - Alberta does not have a waitlist.

Q: What is the rollout plan for the vaccine? A: Alberta Health, with input from Alberta Health Services, has identified the key populations to be included in the province's phased immunization program. Exact amounts and timelines are subject to change. The approach will be amended as needed depending on vaccine supply.

Early Phase 1: December 2020 Focus on acute care sites with the highest COVID-19 capacity concerns: Healthcare workers in intensive care units, Respiratory therapists, Staff in long term care (LTC) and designated supportive living (DSL) facilities.

Phase 1A: January - March 2021 Respiratory therapists, Healthcare workers in intensive care units, Staff in LTC and DSL facilities. Home care workers, Healthcare workers in emergency departments, All residents of LTC and DSL facilities, regardless of age, Healthcare workers in COVID-19 units, medical and surgical units and operating rooms, Paramedics, and emergency medical responders. Seniors 75 years of age and over, no matter where they live, First Nations, Métis and persons 65 years of age and over living in a First Nations community or Metis Settlement. Feb. 19th, AHS will vaccinate residents in retirement centres, lodges, supportive living, and other congregate living facilities with people 75 or older. Albertans 75+ (born 1946 or earlier) can book their appointment starting Wednesday February 24th.

Phase 2: April to September 2021 Phase 2 is broken into Groups A to D. Vaccinations for each group will begin once the previous group has been completed. Timelines are subject to change depending on vaccine supply. Detailed information on how eligible Albertans will receive the vaccine will be released prior to each group.

Phase 3: Fall 2021 Anticipated start of roll-out to the general public.

<https://www.alberta.ca/covid19-vaccine.aspx>

Executive Director Report

As we are gradually moving out of the extreme cold, now is the time to look forward to having received our vaccinations and meeting together again. Gordon mentioned in his Presidents' Report, that COVID-19 has affected us all in ways we never thought would happen. I hope that you have been keeping in touch with your friends and family through phone calls and other media methods such as Zoom and Skype. It is important that we do not allow ourselves to become isolated for our own well-being and the safety of those living on their own.

Thanks to Zoom, I have been able to continue to attend meetings with other senior organizations. Both Public Interest Alberta Senior task force and Edmonton Coordinating Council Stewardship Roundtable meetings have provided information on how we can help our seniors in the province. The Pharmacare Working Group for the province has become more active in recent weeks due to the introduction of Bill C-213. It is a new federal legislation to establish a universal, single pager public pharmacare plan that will deliver better health care to Canadians. Please check out the website on Bill C-213 and contact your local Member of Parliament to show your support. If passed, it could be law by next spring.

Finally, I encourage all members to attend our AGM on April 28th via Zoom.

Respectfully submitted, Linda Osborne sunexdir@telus.net cell: 780-920-3058

Our next Cash Raffle is: "Volunteer Virtues"

Draw Date April 19, 2021 License #570434

See page 11 for ticket order form or

purchase online: www.seniorsunitednow.com

Tickets \$5.00 each 5 Tickets \$10.00 20 tickets \$20.00

Please consider supporting SUN's critical fundraising.

Checkout our Volunteer Salutes – on page 4



Office of the Seniors Advocate

The following position paper was developed by CARP – Calgary Chapter 10, for presentation to the Hon. Jason Kenney. The presentation is planned for the month of April 2021. Seniors United Now at the regular Board Meeting held by zoom on January 6, 2021 voted unanimously to support CARP in their petition to the Alberta Provincial Government to reinstate the Office of the Seniors Advocate under separate legislation.

At present more than forty seniors' organizations have provided written support for the presentation.

Calgary Chapter10

To all Albertan Older Adults and the Children and Caregivers of Older Adults:

This message is from the Calgary Chapter of C.A.R.P.(Canadian Association of Retired Persons) "A New Vision for Aging". We are Canada's largest advocacy association for older Canadians, and among other things, we promote equitable access to health care, financial security, and freedom from ageism.

CARP Calgary is petitioning the Alberta Provincial Government to reinstate the Seniors Advocate Office. In 2016 the first permanent Seniors Advocate Sheree Kwong, was appointed. But it was not enshrined in legislation, so at the end of December of 2019 the current government did not renew the ministerial order that had created the Office.

Alberta has seven other advocate offices, all created via legislation, so they are not easily discontinued. Currently, older adult health issues are handled through the Health Advocate. As we all know, health is only a part of the issue's older adults face in Alberta. Housing, financial challenges, abuse, isolation, food security, and many other issues face older adults in Alberta. While the Seniors Advocate Office was in place, they looked after more issues than the other four health related Advocates.

CARP Calgary is gaining support on this issue from many seniors' organizations in Alberta as well as some MLA's. We are also working with CARP Chapters in Saskatchewan and Manitoba as well as our National organization on this issue. British Columbia already has a Seniors Advocate, and if we are successful in all the three provinces, we will have a strong voice in Western Canada.

If you support this proposal, please contact your constituent MLA and talk to them about the need for Seniors Advocate Office. Phone calls are going to be the most effective way of pressuring the Alberta Government on this issue. Now is an opportune time for this, as COVID-19 has highlighted many of the issue's older adults face (social isolation, abuse, lack of protection from contamination to name a few).

Please consider using the points below when speaking with your MLA. And if you have any related personal stories where the Seniors Advocate Office would have helped you, please do share those with your MLA.

1. A Seniors Advocate helps older persons, or their family members or caregivers, to resolve issues, as well as provide information and recommendations to various stakeholders and government as to trends, necessary policies, and programs.
2. Older adults in Alberta are your most consistent and, by percentages, largest group of voters.
3. When the very busy Office of the Seniors Advocate was terminated at the end of December 2019, all health issues being experienced by older adults were forwarded to the Office of the Health Advocate. However only about 25% of the issues addressed by the Seniors Advocate (according to her final, never released, report from the Seniors Advocate's Office) were about health challenges. The rest included housing, eldercare, finances, interpersonal violence issues and ageism. Older adults, their families and caregivers now have no voice in resolving such issues.
4. The Office of the Seniors Advocate must be legislated so that the Seniors Advocate is appointed by the Lieutenant Governor and reports directly to the Legislature. Politics must be removed from the Office so that the whims of the governing parties or their ministries do not interfere with the work of the Office nor the Seniors Advocate her/himself.

If you would like to know more about this advocacy project, please do contact us at carpcalgary@gmail.com

We look forward to your participation in the reinstatement of the Office of the Seniors Advocate.

What to expect when the Canada Revenue Agency contacts you

Scammers posing as the Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) continue to mislead Canadians.

How to know it's really the CRA:

The CRA may...

- Ask for personal information (name, date of birth, social insurance number).
- Ask for details about your account (business enquiry).
- Call you or write to you to begin an audit process.
- Notify you by email when something is available for you to view in CRA's digital services.
- Email you a CRA link, form, or publication when you request one during a call or a meeting with an agent.
- Ask for financial information such as the name of your bank and its location.
- Send you a notice of assessment or reassessment.
- Ask you to pay an amount you owe through any of the CRA's payment options.
- Take legal action to recover the money you owe if you refuse to pay your debt.

The CRA will never...

- Ask for information about your passport, health card, or driver's license.
- Demand immediate payment.
- Accept payment by bitcoin, prepaid credit cards or gift cards.
- Use aggressive language or threaten to arrest or deport you.
- Send you an email with a link to your refund.
- Leave voicemails that are threatening or give personal or financial information.
- Give or ask for personal or financial information by email and ask you to click on a link.
- Email you a link asking you to fill in an online form with personal or financial details.
- Set up a meeting in a public place to take a payment.

Check your tax account: Confirm your tax account information through one of the CRA's digital services. Call the CRA's Individual Tax Account Balance Automated Service at 1-866-474-8272. **Call 1-800-959-8281**

If you think you may be the victim of fraud or you unknowingly provided personal or financial information, contact your local police service, financial institution, and credit reporting agencies.

To report: antifraudcentre.ca or call 1-888-495-8501

More information on tax scams and fraud can be found at canada.ca/taxes-fraud-prevention.

The CRA never uses text messages or instant messaging such as Facebook, Messenger, or WhatsApp to communicate with taxpayers.

AGM REGISTRATION

We are requesting members to register for the April 28th Annual General Meeting. We need to achieve a Quorum of 50(fifty) current members. Please consider attending. You may attend online via zoom or by phone. *Zoom account is **NOT** required to participate.

Online registration: www.seniorsunitednow.com

Page 12 for a mail in registration. For members that would like to participate by phone contact the SUN office to register: 780-449-1816



St. Albert & Calgary Chapter

Currently there are no leadership volunteers for a chapter steering committee. These chapters will be in hiatus until volunteers are recruited. For further information please contact: SUN Executive Director Linda Osborne
Cell: 780-920-3058 Email: sunexdir@telus.net

Volunteer Virtues ...We Celebrate YOU!

Name(s): _____

Address: _____

Phone # _____ For Office USE: _____

Email _____
(please print)

Individual Tickets: _____ Tickets \$5.00 each \$ _____ (50 available)

5 tickets \$10.00 _____ Sets \$10.00 each \$ _____ (50 sets available)

20 tickets \$20.00 _____ Sets \$20.00 each \$ _____ (50 sets available)

Draw Date April 19, 2021**License #570434****Please make your cheque
payable to SUN****RAFFLE RULES**

1) Raffle tickets must not be sold to a person under the age of 18 years.

2) The purchase price of each ticket shall be: \$5.00 each OR 5 tickets \$10.00 OR 20 tickets \$20.00

3) To be eligible for draws, the ticket order and purchase amount must be received in SUN office by 10:00am, April 19, 2021

4) The prize payout shall be as follows:

1st prize 30% of the gross ticket sale revenue**2nd prize 20% of the gross ticket sale revenue**

5) The draw(s) shall be made at the SUN office: #37 2016 Sherwood Drive, Sherwood Park, AB T8A3X3 prior to 3pm, April 19, 2021

6) The winning ticket buyers shall be notified by telephone; their names will be publicized in the next newsletter & on the SUN website. The winning ticket buyers will be awarded the prize via cheque drawn on SUN.

7) In the event of any concern or dispute regarding this raffle, please contact Lynn Penner at the SUN administration office. 780-449-1816

8) Raffle tickets are official when payment is received & numbers issued by the sun raffle chairman.

9) Your Ticket numbers are available by contacting the SUN office

SUN MEMBERSHIP Renewal / Donation January – March 2021Individual: ☐ \$25 per year ☐ \$50 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$200Joint: ☐ \$40 per year ☐ \$80 2 years Lifetime: ☐ \$300**Donation in addition to membership dues**☐ \$5 ☐ \$10 ☐ \$15 ☐ \$20 ☐ \$25 ☐ other \$ _____Renewal \$ _____ Donation \$ _____ Raffle \$ _____ **Please make cheque payable to Seniors United Now**Signed Cheque(s) enclosed **Chq#** _____ **Total \$** _____ Your stamp on our return envelope helps us reduce postage costs

Membership # _____ (see Back Page)

Joint Member (if applicable) Membership # _____

☐ YES - replace my membership card☐ YES - replace my membership card**(Please attach a stamped self-addressed stamped envelope if you are requesting a replacement card)**

Name: _____

Name: _____

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Year of Birth: _____ (used for SUN demographics only)

Address: _____

(If different from mailing label on reverse)

Renew your membership online! SUN uses the PayPal system, for secure online renewals & donations**Etransfer may also be used for membership payments. Email: unitenow@telus.net**

Phone: _____ Email: _____ (send me electronic SUN information)

(please print clearly)

☐ YES – I am interested in volunteering, please contact me.

**SEE PAGE 3 – note
ADMINISTRATION MODIFICATION
TO MEMBERSHIP RENEWAL
DATES / TERM**



AGM REGISTRATION

Online registration available visit:

www.seniorsunitednow.com

Name(s):

Membership # _____ (see Below)

Phone:

Email: (please print)

Return Undeliverable Canadian

Addresses to:

Unit #37 15 - 2016 Sherwood Drive,
Sherwood Park, Alberta, T8A 3X3

Canadian publication

Agreement No. 40917510

Thank-you for being a
SUN member, your
membership is: